

Math anxiety

According to a Canadian study, 'the feeling of fear and dread of performing mathematical calculations,' can negatively affect even simple tasks such as counting

Education Bliss

According to a recent New York times article, there's a correlation between education and we-being trends in the US

on them. Featuring multiple notebooks, a web clip feature, and a lot more, you can use Evernote to jot down everything from ideas that popped into your head, to content you stumbled across online. With 40 MB of storage available per month, you can now afford to become a squirrel, and store everything away for later use. Some alternatives include iClippy and the more powerful SpringPad (www.springpadit.com).

The web

It's not like this is news to you. All of us know how important the web is these days when it comes to research, keeping in touch with news and events in your field, or finding ways to understand subjects that your teachers have failed to explain to you properly. Yes, we've often debated ourselves whether you should trust sources such as Wikipedia, because they're not always accurate. Then there's the fact that knowledge is often localised – add a map of India from a foreign site into a project and you will probably hit a raw nerve, or just get marks cut. In general, though, the web is a treasure trove. However, how do you sort through trillions of web pages to find what you want?

Search

First up, you should learn how to use search engines properly. Advanced search techniques are something we've covered a lot of in previous issues. However, it's not just how to use a search engine, but which search engines to use for what, that's what really matters. For subjects such as Math, especially complex operations such as calculus, Wolfram|Alpha has some useful apps for mobiles that you will find very handy. You can have integration and differentiation solved in a matter of seconds. All you need to do is key in the equation on your phone and Wolfram|Alpa will solve it for you.

We've also got a primer on the deep web in this issue itself, on page 50, so be sure to read that article as well, so that you can find useful information that not everyone else can.

Network

Facebook, Orkut and the like are not just good for flirting with the opposite sex, or

making contacts. You can also use them to set up study groups, and collaborate your efforts. A lot of students find it beneficial to study in groups, and every management institute praises the merits of collaboration of minds on a single project.

On the go

A lot of us read or study while we're traveling, and that's when you might get stuck at something. It could be a forgotten formula, the meaning of a word, or just an email that you were supposed to send for the boss, but forgot about, while rushing home to catch the end of a match. A lot of mobile operators offer GPRS / EDGE / WAP services on a pay per use basis, and this is exactly what you need. So long as you don't go crazy downloading ringtones for your mobile, you will find that having this option available to you is indeed a life-saver at times. Even if you have an old mobile, without mobile internet features, you can use Google SMS to get answers.

Rudradeep Biswas uses Google SMS search while travelling. This way he always stays connected to the internet without

having a GPRS connection. All you need to do is send your search query as an SMS to 9773300000. However, when we tried using it for some Math formulae, we didn't get results as relevant as those on the web site.

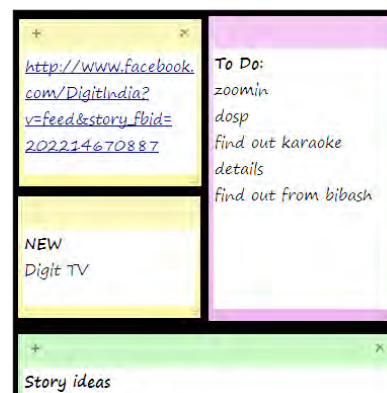
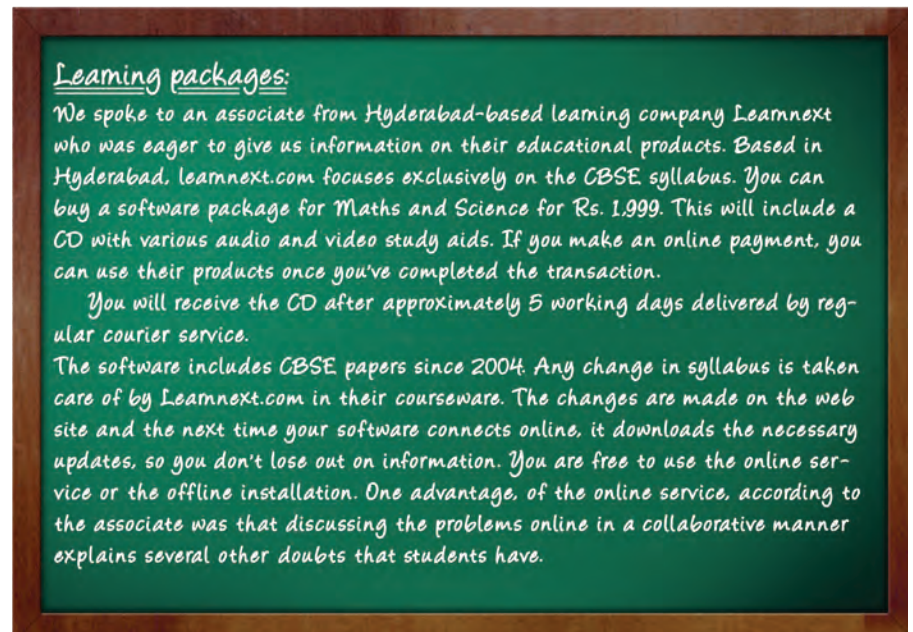
In addition to search, your mobile phone has several other uses as well. Shivaram Krishnan uses a mobile dictionary on his cell phone. Whenever he comes across a word he can't understand, all he needs to do is look it up on his mobile.

It's all in your head

Although technology can help you in many ways, the solution to all your problems is to just get smarter. If you can remember more, associate better, and sharpen your mind, you're bound to go further in life. Technology has a few solutions for you in this regard as well:

Remember Stuff

Sometimes low-tech works better than the latest digital gimmickry. Little yellow post-it notes, or fridge notes are a good mechanism to remember things. Now if only you could carry your fridge around with



Stickers in Windows 7